ZATCA · Phase 2

4 things about ZATCA integration nobody tells you

I learned them building an e-invoicing engine solo, all the way through the real production gateway.



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Who needs this

SAR 187,500

The Wave 25 threshold. Deadline: 1 February 2027

Any business above this in taxable revenue in any year from 2022 to 2025.
That means a lot of businesses integrating for the first time.



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1

Your Arabic company name can vanish from the CSR

openssl drops the field with non-English characters,
and what comes after it.
With no error.



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2

A sandbox pass proves nothing

The test environment isn't production.
Don't say "done" until the production certificate is issued
and the first real invoice clears.



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3

Don't touch the XML after the hash

Any reformatting after you compute the hash means it won't match.
And ZATCA rejects the invoice.



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4

An unsent invoice has to give its number back

The invoice counter (ICV) must never repeat.
Cancel an invoice without returning its number,
and the next one gets the same number.



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Save this

Before you say "integration done"

1. Test an Arabic company name in the CSR
2. Sign after the last change to the XML
3. Put a unique index on the counter
4. If the totals don't add up, reject the invoice. Don't guess.



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I'm Mohammed. I build products, and the machine that sells them, from Riyadh.

Save this, and tell me in the comments:
which ZATCA error held you up the longest?



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